

NGO RESEARCH & DATA COLLECTION

A Structured Study of 10 NGOs Working Across India's Social Sectors

Prepared as part of: TASK 1 — Research & Data Collection Assignment

Sectors Covered: Education | Child Welfare | Women Empowerment | Healthcare | Animal Welfare | Environmental
Conservation | Disaster Relief

Date: 21 August 2026

1. Objective

The purpose of this exercise is to research and document how non-governmental organisations (NGOs) operate across different social sectors in India, and to build practical data-collection and secondary-research skills. Ten NGOs spanning education, child welfare, women empowerment, healthcare/nutrition, animal welfare, environmental conservation and disaster relief were studied, and their information was organised into a structured, comparable format for easy reference and analysis.

2. Scope & Methodology

Information was gathered through secondary research using each organisation's official website and other publicly available, credible sources (Wikipedia, verified nonprofit directories, and recent news coverage), and was cross-checked across sources where possible for accuracy. For each NGO, five data points were captured: Name, Official Website, Area/Sector of Work, Headquarters Location, and Key Initiatives/Flagship Programmes.

- Data points collected: NGO Name, Website, Sector, Year Founded, Headquarters, Key Initiatives
- Sources used: Official NGO websites, Wikipedia, nonprofit directories (e.g., Idealist, CB Insights), news archives
- Sectors represented: Education, Child Welfare, Women Empowerment, Healthcare/Nutrition, Animal Welfare, Environmental Conservation, Disaster Relief

3. NGO Data Summary Table

The table below presents the consolidated findings for all 10 NGOs studied, organised for quick comparison across sectors.

#	NGO Name & Website	Sector	Founded	Headquarters	Key Initiatives
1	Pratham Education Foundation www.pratham.org	Education	1995	Mumbai, Maharashtra (with a major office in New Delhi)	Annual Status of Education Report (ASER) — India's largest citizen-led household survey on children's schooling and learning outcomes; Read India / foundational literacy & numeracy programmes; Pratham Skilling vocational training for youth employability; early-childhood (balwadi) education and digital/tech-enabled learning (PraDigi).
2	Teach For India www.teachforindia.org	Education	2009	Mumbai, Maharashtra	Two-year Fellowship placing college graduates and working professionals as full-time teachers in low-income schools; Alumni movement driving long-term systemic change; Innovation Cell supporting student- and teacher-led projects; Firki teacher-training platform (part of the global Teach For All network).
3	CRY – Child Rights and You www.cry.org	Child Welfare & Education	1979	Mumbai, Maharashtra (branch offices in Delhi,	Grant-making and capacity-building support to grassroots partner NGOs across 19+ states; grassroots and policy-level advocacy on

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				Bengaluru, Chennai, Kolkata)	the 4 Rights of the Child — education, health & nutrition, protection, and participation; campaigns against child labour, child marriage and trafficking.
4	Goonj www.goonj.org	Disaster Relief & Rural Development	1999	New Delhi	'Cloth for Work' — repurposing urban discards (clothing, household material) as a resource/wage for rural development work such as road repair and well-digging; 'Not Just a Piece of Cloth' — sustainable cloth-based sanitary napkins for rural women; Rahat — annual disaster and flood relief; 'School to School' education-material drive.
5	SEWA – Self Employed Women's Association www.sewa.org	Women Empowerment	1972	Ahmedabad, Gujarat	India's largest trade union of women workers in the informal economy (~2 million members); SEWA Bank offering micro-savings, credit and insurance; skill-building and vocational cooperatives; Mahila Housing Trust for affordable housing and living conditions; advocacy for social security and full employment.
6	Akshaya Patra Foundation www.akshayapatra.org	Healthcare & Nutrition (School Feeding)	2000	Bengaluru, Karnataka	World's largest NGO-run school Mid-Day Meal Programme, implementing partner of the Government of India's PM POSHAN scheme; centralised kitchens serving over 2 million children daily across many states; food relief and grocery-kit distribution during emergencies and disasters.
7	Wildlife SOS www.wildlifesos.org	Animal Welfare & Wildlife Conservation	1995	New Delhi	Rescue and rehabilitation of sloth bears (ending the 'dancing bear' practice) and captive elephants; human–wildlife conflict mitigation for leopards, macaques and snakes; anti-poaching operations and habitat/biodiversity conservation; alternative-livelihood programmes for communities once dependent on wildlife exploitation.
8	WWF-India (World Wide Fund for Nature-India) www.wwfindia.org	Environmental Conservation	1969	New Delhi	Forest and biodiversity conservation through participatory, stakeholder-driven approaches; climate change and energy conservation programmes; Environment Education Programme / Education for Sustainable Development for schools; species and habitat protection projects across river, forest and marine landscapes.
9	HelpAge India www.helpageindia.org	Healthcare & Elderly Welfare	1978	New Delhi	Mobile Healthcare Units and free cataract-surgery camps for underserved elderly in rural and urban areas; elder helpline and protection services against abuse and neglect; livelihood and pension-linkage support; disaster relief support for older persons.

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10	Smile Foundation www.smilefoundationindia.org	Education & Healthcare	2002	New Delhi	Mission Education learning centres for underprivileged children across 400+ project locations; 'Shiksha Na Ruke' blended/digital learning continuity programme; women's livelihood and skilling initiatives (e.g., iTrain on Wheels); healthcare outreach and disaster-relief response.

4. Sector-wise Snapshot

- Education: Pratham, Teach For India
- Child Welfare & Education: CRY – Child Rights and You
- Disaster Relief & Rural Development: Goonj
- Women Empowerment: SEWA
- Healthcare & Nutrition: Akshaya Patra Foundation
- Animal Welfare & Wildlife Conservation: Wildlife SOS
- Environmental Conservation: WWF-India
- Healthcare & Elderly Welfare: HelpAge India
- Education & Healthcare: Smile Foundation

5. Key Observations & Learnings

A few patterns emerged consistently across the NGOs studied:

- Most well-established NGOs run one or two flagship, easily-recognisable programmes (e.g., ASER for Pratham, the Mid-Day Meal Programme for Akshaya Patra) that serve as their primary public identity, alongside several smaller supporting initiatives.
- Many organisations partner closely with central or state governments to scale impact (Akshaya Patra with PM POSHAN; Pratham and Teach For India with state education departments), rather than working in isolation.
- Delhi-NCR, Mumbai and Bengaluru are common headquarters hubs, though field operations for most NGOs extend across many states, particularly rural and semi-urban India.
- Founders often remain closely associated with the identity of the organisation (e.g., Ela Bhatt with SEWA, Anshu Gupta with Goonj), and long operating histories (several NGOs are 25–50+ years old) correlate with wider geographic reach.

- Sector boundaries are often blurred in practice — e.g., Smile Foundation and CRY work across education, health and gender simultaneously — reflecting how grassroots needs are interconnected rather than siloed.

6. Sources & References

Data was compiled from the official websites of each NGO listed in the table above, supplemented by:

- Wikipedia entries for each organisation
- Nonprofit directories: Idealist.org, CB Insights
- News coverage from Tribune India, PTI and other verified outlets (for recent programme updates)

Note: Figures such as beneficiary counts and number of states covered change frequently as these organisations scale their work; readers should verify current statistics on the respective official websites before citing them externally.